

HR CHAT POLICY

Policy for HR Chatbot / HR Helpdesk Communication

Version 1.0

Effective Date: [DD/MM/YYYY]

Owner: Human Resources Department

Approved By: [HR Head / Management]

Document Control

Policy Name	HR Chat Policy
Document Owner	Human Resources Department
Applies To	All employees, interns, contractors, HR team members, and authorized users
Review Frequency	Every 6 months or whenever legal, HR, or system changes occur
Status	Draft / Approved

1. Purpose

The purpose of this HR Chat Policy is to define the rules, responsibilities, privacy expectations, and usage standards for communication through the HR chat system, HR chatbot, or HR helpdesk chat channel. This policy helps ensure that HR-related conversations are professional, confidential, accurate, and compliant with company standards.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all users who access or interact with the HR chat system, including employees, interns, contractors, HR staff, managers, administrators, and any authorized third-party support teams.

- HR chatbot conversations and automated HR responses
- Manual HR helpdesk chat conversations
- Queries related to leave, attendance, payroll, benefits, policies, onboarding, documents, and employee support
- Any HR-related data shared through chat, attachments, forms, or integrated systems

3. Definitions

Term	Meaning
HR Chat System	A digital chat channel, chatbot, or helpdesk tool used for HR-related communication.
User	Any person who accesses or communicates through the HR chat system.
Sensitive HR Data	Personal, employment, payroll, health, identity, grievance, disciplinary, or confidential employee information.
Bot Response	An automated response generated by the HR chatbot or AI assistant.
Escalation	Transfer of a chat query to an HR representative, manager, admin, or authorized support person.

4. Policy Statement

The HR chat system must be used only for legitimate HR and employee-support purposes. All users must maintain respectful communication, protect confidential information, and avoid misuse of the system. The chat system is intended to provide quick HR assistance, but it does not replace official HR decisions, signed company documents, legal notices, or management approvals.

5. Acceptable Use

Users may use the HR chat system for the following purposes:

- Asking questions about company HR policies, leave rules, attendance, payroll dates, benefits, onboarding, exit process, and employee documents.
- Submitting HR service requests, such as leave clarification, profile update requests, payslip support, ID card support, and document requests.
- Receiving guidance about HR procedures and next steps.
- Checking status updates where the system supports status tracking.
- Requesting escalation to an HR representative when the chatbot answer is unclear or insufficient.

6. Prohibited Use

Users must not use the HR chat system for any of the following:

- Sharing passwords, OTPs, private keys, or login credentials.
- Uploading or requesting unauthorized access to another employee's personal or HR records.
- Using abusive, threatening, discriminatory, harassing, or unprofessional language.
- Making false claims, impersonating another person, or submitting misleading information.
- Attempting to manipulate, reverse-engineer, overload, or bypass system restrictions.
- Sharing confidential company data that is not required for the HR request.
- Using the chat system for non-HR, personal, political, promotional, or unrelated activities.

7. Privacy and Confidentiality

HR chat conversations may contain confidential and personal information. The organization must handle this information with appropriate care and restrict access to authorized personnel only.

- Only authorized HR staff, system administrators, or approved support personnel may access HR chat records when required for support, compliance, investigation, or audit purposes.
- Users should share only the minimum information required to resolve their HR query.
- Sensitive HR data must not be disclosed in group chats, public channels, or unsecured platforms.
- The HR team must not share employee information with unauthorized persons.
- Any accidental disclosure of sensitive information must be reported immediately to HR or the designated security contact.

8. Data Collection and Retention

The HR chat system may collect and store chat messages, timestamps, user identifiers, uploaded attachments, query categories, chatbot responses, escalation notes, and resolution status. Retention periods should follow company policy and applicable legal requirements.

Data Type	Purpose	Suggested Retention
Chat transcripts	Support history, quality review, audit, dispute resolution	6-24 months or as per company policy
Attachments	Verification of employee requests	As required for the request or legal retention
System logs	Security monitoring and troubleshooting	90-365 days
Feedback ratings	Service improvement	6-12 months

9. AI Chatbot Response Limitations

If an AI chatbot is used, users must understand that automated responses may be based on available company documents, configured rules, and system data. The chatbot may not always understand complex, outdated, missing, or exceptional cases.

- Bot responses are for guidance and support only unless clearly marked as official approval.
- Final decisions related to payroll, disciplinary action, hiring, termination, legal matters, and policy exceptions must be handled by authorized HR or management personnel.
- If a response seems incorrect, unclear, incomplete, or sensitive, the user should request escalation to HR.
- The chatbot must clearly indicate when it cannot answer and must provide an escalation option where possible.

10. Escalation Rules

The HR chat system must support escalation to a human HR representative in the following cases:

- Payroll errors, salary deductions, tax issues, or benefits disputes
- Harassment, discrimination, grievance, disciplinary, or workplace safety concerns
- Medical, legal, personal emergency, or sensitive employee issues
- Requests involving confidential documents or identity verification
- Cases where the chatbot cannot find a reliable answer
- Cases where the employee asks to speak with HR directly

11. Security Requirements

The organization should maintain reasonable security controls for the HR chat system.

- User authentication should be required before accessing personal HR data.
- Role-based access control should restrict data access based on job responsibilities.
- Sensitive data should be encrypted in transit and, where applicable, at rest.
- Audit logs should record access to sensitive HR information.
- System administrators must not access chat data unless there is a valid support, security, compliance, or audit reason.
- Integrations with payroll, attendance, ERP, or document systems must use secure APIs and approved credentials.

12. Communication Standards

All communication through the HR chat system must be professional and respectful.

- Use clear and polite language.
- Avoid offensive, threatening, or discriminatory content.
- Do not use slang or unclear abbreviations for official HR requests.
- Provide accurate details when raising a request.
- Do not repeatedly submit duplicate requests unless the issue remains unresolved after the expected response time.

13. Monitoring and Quality Review

The company may monitor HR chat activity for service quality, security, compliance, troubleshooting, training, and audit purposes. Monitoring must be limited to authorized purposes and should respect employee privacy.

14. Employee Rights and Responsibilities

Employee Rights

- To receive respectful and timely HR support.
- To request escalation to a human HR representative for sensitive or unclear issues.
- To request correction of inaccurate personal information through the proper HR process.
- To know that HR chat data may be stored and reviewed for legitimate business reasons.

Employee Responsibilities

- Use the HR chat system only for HR-related purposes.
- Share accurate and necessary information only.
- Protect confidential information and avoid sharing another employee's data.
- Report suspected misuse, privacy incidents, or incorrect chatbot responses.

15. HR Team Responsibilities

- Maintain accurate HR knowledge base content and update outdated policies promptly.
- Handle employee queries fairly, confidentially, and professionally.
- Review escalated conversations and provide appropriate resolutions.
- Ensure chatbot responses do not conflict with approved HR policies.
- Train HR users on privacy, confidentiality, and escalation procedures.

16. Incident Reporting

Any suspected misuse, data leak, unauthorized access, incorrect sensitive response, harassment, or policy violation must be reported immediately to HR, the reporting manager, or the designated security/contact person. The organization should investigate incidents based on severity and take appropriate corrective action.

17. Disciplinary Action

Violation of this policy may result in corrective or disciplinary action according to company policy. Serious violations may lead to access restriction, formal warning, termination of employment or contract, and legal action where applicable.

18. Policy Review and Updates

This policy should be reviewed at least every six months or whenever there are changes in HR processes, company policies, chatbot functionality, data protection requirements, or legal obligations. Updated versions must be communicated to all relevant users.

19. Standard HR Chat Disclaimer

The following disclaimer may be displayed at the beginning of the HR chat experience:

"This HR chat system provides general HR support and guidance based on available company information. Do not share passwords, OTPs, or unnecessary sensitive data. Some conversations may be stored and reviewed by authorized personnel for support, quality, compliance, and security purposes. For confidential, legal, payroll, grievance, or emergency matters, please request escalation to HR."

20. Acknowledgement

By using the HR chat system, users acknowledge that they have read, understood, and agree to follow this HR Chat Policy.

21. Approval

Name	Designation	Signature	Date

Appendix A: HR Chat Request Categories

- Leave and attendance queries
- Payroll and payslip support
- Benefits and insurance
- Onboarding and joining formalities
- Exit and clearance process
- Policy clarification
- Employee documents and certificates
- Profile update requests
- Grievance or escalation request
- Technical issue with HR portal or chatbot